

Course Outline: Economics of Global Shifts

Winter 2025

Course Information

- **Instructor:** [Muhebullah Karimzada]
- **Course Code:** [ECON 220]
- **Class Schedule:** [Asynchronous]
- **Classroom:** [TBA]
- **Office Hours:** [TBA]
- **Email:** [TBA]

Course Description

This course explores the concept of global economic shifts and how they impact regions such as Northern British Columbia (NBC). Topics include the effects of technological advancements, demographic changes, trade, environmental factors, and geopolitical dynamics on local and global economies. Using NBC as a case study, students will analyze how regions adapt to and leverage these global shifts for sustainable economic growth. The course will also examine Indigenous perspectives and the role of local communities in navigating economic transitions.

Course Objectives

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Define and understand global economic shifts.
- Identify key global drivers such as technology, trade, and demographics.
- Analyze the impacts of these shifts on Northern British Columbia's economy.
- Evaluate strategies for balancing economic growth with sustainability.
- Discuss the role of Indigenous communities in regional development.

Required Texts and Materials

- Stiglitz, J. E. (2002). *Globalization and Its Discontents*.
- Bowles, P., & Wilson, M. (2015). *Resource Communities in a Globalizing Region*.
- Prince Rupert Port Authority (2023). *Annual Reports*.
- Additional readings will be provided via the course website.

Course Topics and Schedule

- **Week 1: Introduction to Global Economic Shifts**
 - What are global economic shifts?
 - Key drivers of global shifts (technology, trade, demographics).
- **Week 2: The Impact of Technology on Global and Local Economies**
 - Technological advancements and automation.
 - Case studies on technology's role in reshaping industries in NBC.
- **Week 3: Trade and Economic Integration**
 - Free trade agreements and their impact on regional economies.
 - NBC's position within the Asia-Pacific trade network.
- **Week 4: Environmental and Climate Changes**
 - The global shift towards sustainability.
 - The role of renewable energy and sustainable practices in NBC's development.
- **Week 5: Demographic Changes and their Economic Implications**
 - Aging populations and labor force changes.
 - Outmigration and youth retention in Northern BC.
- **Week 6: Geopolitical Dynamics and Economic Shifts**
 - Global trade tensions, sanctions, and their effects on NBC.
 - NBC's reliance on international markets.
- **Week 7: Indigenous Perspectives in Economic Development**
 - Indigenous community involvement in resource development.
 - Case study: Joint ventures and Indigenous-led projects.
- **Week 8: Case Study: Prince Rupert Port**
 - Growth of the port and its economic significance.

- Environmental and community impacts.
- **Week 9: NBC's Economic Challenges and Opportunities**
 - Diversifying the economy beyond resource extraction.
 - Strategies for sustainable growth and development.
- **Week 10: Final Exam Review and Conclusion**
 - Recap of key concepts and course discussions.
 - Preparation for final exam.

Grading and Assessment

- **Participation:** 10%
- **Midterm Exam:** 30%
- **Case Study Presentation:** 20%
- **Final Exam:** 40%

Course Policies

- **Attendance:** Regular attendance is expected. If you are unable to attend a class, please inform the instructor in advance.
- **Late Submissions:** Late assignments will be penalized 5% per day, unless otherwise arranged with the instructor.
- **Academic Integrity:** Students are expected to adhere to the University's academic integrity policies. Any form of plagiarism or cheating will not be tolerated.

Discussion Questions for Reflection

- What are the main global trends affecting Northern British Columbia's economy?
- How can Northern British Columbia balance economic growth with environmental sustainability?
- What role should Indigenous communities play in the economic development of Northern British Columbia?